Evidence of Student Learning: Anonymized Metacognitive Reflections

Rhetorical Discernment in AI-Assisted Business Writing (COMM 3093)

Course Framework: Critical Teaching Behaviors (CTB) — **ALIGN Core Learning Outcome #2:** *Use generative AI strategically across the writing process and improve drafts using human judgment.* **Assessment:** Individual In-Class Metacognitive Reflection (Timed, 450–650 words) **Evaluation Standard:** Assessed against Criterion 3 (*Judgment About AI Use and Human Agency*) and Criterion 4 (*Metacognitive Reflection on Collaboration, Outcomes, and Growth*) of the course reflection rubric.

Executive Summary of Assessment Findings

- **Overall Fluency: Two-thirds (67%) of students** demonstrated operational fluency in rhetorical discernment—the capacity to evaluate, modify, or intentionally reject AI-generated content based on audience, purpose, local context, and genre conventions.

- **Pedagogical Alignment:** Student reflections validated the backward-designed structure: scaffolding AI through the **Student AI Use Scale** (University of Kentucky CELT) gave students a concrete vocabulary for justifying when to accept, adapt, or override generative AI outputs.

Curated Student Reflection Excerpts

Excerpt 1: Rejection of Generic Output for Local Rhetorical Context

> *"AI was useful for brainstorming taglines, audience charts, and initial hooks, but it consistently produced generic support that missed our local context entirely—like failing to understand Newman's Jets Broadcast platform or student culture. We had to reject suggestions that sounded robotic and rewrite them so our campaign actually resonated with Newman students and faculty." — **Student Reflection A** (Rubric Score: Strong / 5.0 pts on AI Judgment) Key Alignment Demonstrated: Rejection and revision driven by audience and community specificity.*

Excerpt 2: Preserving Human Voice Against Cliché and Flattened Prose

> *"While AI helped with organization and maintaining message consistency across all four milestones, its suggestions quickly drifted into clichés, mundane phrasing, and unnatural tone for college students. Human judgment was essential at every*

*step to step in, preserve our original voice, and make the writing compelling and authentic." — **Student Reflection B** (Rubric Score: Strong / 5.0 pts on AI Judgment) Key Alignment Demonstrated: Human agency overcoming algorithmic formulaicism to protect stylistic voice.*

Excerpt 3: Moderating AI Use to Protect Originality and Purpose

*"We used AI to test campaign naming and refine our calls to action, but we realized early on that overusing it started flattening our originality. We made the deliberate choice to moderate our AI use, discard weaker suggestions that did not fit our vision, and keep our core message community-centered through our own writing." — **Student Reflection C** (Rubric Score: Strong / 5.0 pts on AI Judgment) Key Alignment Demonstrated: Metacognitive self-regulation and intentional moderation along the AI Use Scale.*

Excerpt 4: Collaborative Revision and Multi-Genre Repurposing

*"AI helped give us initial structural ideas when we felt stuck, but turning those raw ideas into a cohesive recommendation report required human synthesis. AI cannot understand the nuances of persuading donors versus informing students. We had to critically analyze what we had created across the milestones and reshape it into a professional, evidence-based argument." — **Student Reflection D** (Rubric Score: Strong / 5.0 pts on AI Judgment) Key Alignment Demonstrated: Genre awareness and the cognitive work of synthesis vs. simple automated compilation.*

Rubric Benchmark: Criterion 3 (Judgment About AI Use and Human Agency)

Level	Criteria Description
Strong (4–5 pts)	Reflection thoughtfully explains how AI helped or hindered the work and clearly identifies the human judgment still required. Shows awareness of limits, choices, responsible use, and the continuing role of human agency in shaping the final work.
Proficient (3–3.75 pts)	Reflection explains AI's role with reasonable clarity and acknowledges some human judgment, though the analysis may be somewhat general or incomplete.

Developing (2–2.5 pts)	Reflection mentions AI use but gives only limited explanation of how it helped, hindered, or required human oversight.
Limited (1 pt)	Reflection gives minimal, unclear, or overly simplistic discussion of AI use and human judgment.

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